

Jess Leitner

Brand & Marketing Communications Leader

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Summary

Brand and marketing communications leader with 8+ years of experience building messaging strategies, executive communications, content programs, and integrated campaigns that strengthen brand reputation and employee engagement. Experienced partnering with executive leadership to translate business strategy into compelling narratives across internal and external audiences. Passionate about building brands through clear storytelling, thoughtful communication, and measurable business impact.

Experience

Pluralsight, Remote

Employer Brand Program Manager (December 2024 - August 2026)

Sr. Employer Brand Specialist (July 2021 - December 2024)

- Developed and governed Pluralsight's global employer value proposition and messaging framework, creating a consistent narrative used across recruiting, social media, executive communications, careers content, and employer marketing.
- Built Pluralsight's employee ambassador program from the ground up, creating a scalable advocacy strategy that **generated nearly 1 million organic impressions over 18 months** while strengthening employee engagement, culture, and authentic brand storytelling.
- Developed the employer brand content strategy and curated weekly content that **drove a 40% YoY increase in LinkedIn reach** while maintaining an average 13.5% engagement rate.
- Led the strategy, messaging, and content transformation of the careers site, **expanding it from one page to seven and creating a richer candidate experience** through EVP-driven messaging, employee stories, and video content.
- Developed and executed a strategic employer reputation campaign that **increased Glassdoor ratings from 3.4 to 3.8 in five months**, strengthening employer perception and candidate trust.
- Established messaging standards, brand guidelines, and content frameworks that enabled recruiters, marketers, and leaders to communicate consistently across channels.
- Managed end-to-end communications from strategy through execution, drafting announcements, talking points, FAQs, executive messaging, and multi-channel communications that supported successful launches and organizational initiatives.
- **Managed a \$150K employer brand budget**, optimizing investments across social media, recruitment marketing, events, content, and employer branding initiatives.
- Launched and scaled People of Pluralsight, an employer brand storytelling series featuring employees across the organization that strengthened company culture, increased brand visibility, and showcased authentic employee experiences.

Self Employed, Remote

Content Creator and Book Reviewer (January 2021 - 2025)

- Grew an engaged audience of **50,000+ followers** through an organic content strategy centered on audience insights, platform trends, and community engagement.
- Planned, produced, and optimized **383 pieces of social content** across video, static, and written formats, generating more than **3.3 million views** and **900,000+ likes**.
- Developed end-to-end content strategies—from concept and copywriting to filming, editing, publishing, and performance analysis—to consistently increase reach and engagement.

- Partnered with publishers, bestselling authors, and consumer brands to execute promotional campaigns, ARC launches, sponsored content, and product collaborations that authentically connected with highly engaged audiences.
- Leveraged Instagram analytics and audience behavior to refine content strategy, identify emerging trends, and optimize performance across multiple content formats.
- Built a trusted personal brand recognized for authentic storytelling, community engagement, and consistent audience growth within the online book community.

2U, Maryland (Hybrid)

Junior Brand Strategist

November 2020 - July 2021 | 2U Inc.

- Developed marketing insights using funnel analytics and competitive benchmarking to inform scalable brand strategy
- Created personas to reflect key student
- Made innovative and data-driven recommendations that drove portfolio-wide strategy, challenged the status quo, and positively impacted revenue.
- Crafted hypotheses and action plans to test, evaluate, and scale new initiatives tied to business objectives.

Brand Marketing Coordinator

March 2019 - November 2020 | 2U Inc.

- Led marketing coordination for 5 online graduate programs and 1 certificate program for prestigious universities Harvard, Yale, and Baylor.
- Created segmented email strategies and dynamic content to improve engagement and lead quality.
- Planned and executed webinars and virtual events, aligning messaging with program differentiators and target audiences.
- Identified workflow gaps and implemented scalable solutions, enhancing efficiency across marketing teams and saving team members a combined 80 hours per week.

Shared Services Coordinator

June 2018 - April 2019 | Comcast Spotlight

Management and Marketing Intern

January 2018 - May 2018 | Penn State University

Volunteer

Women@Pluralsight - Community Co-Chair (Sept 2024 - July 2026)

- Plan and Emcee company-wide ERG events to inform, engage, and connect women and allies at Pluralsight.
- Strategically plan initiatives that increase Slack engagement and attendance.
- Partner with other Women@PS chairs and effectively lead the members of the community pillar.

Education

Penn State University (2018)

Bachelor of Science (B.S.), Marketing/Marketing Management

Certifications

- **Search Engine Optimization (SEO) (Jan 2024)** - Hubspot
- **Inclusive Employer Brand (Oct 2023)** - Textio
- **Employer Brand Strategist (2021)** - P.H. Creative

Skills

- **Strategic Skills:** Brand storytelling, EVP lifecycle management, cross-functional leadership, DEI integration, talent marketing, campaign development, social content strategy, brand strategy
- **Creative Skills:** Copywriting, video editing, Canva, Adobe Creative Cloud, communications, campaign creation, presentation decks
- **Platforms:** Workday, Glassdoor, BuiltIn, PowerToFly, Asana, Jira, Stack Overflow, Indeed, LinkedIn, The Muse, Oak Engage
- **Data & Ops:** Marketing analytics, stakeholder alignment, ROI optimization, OKRs, event planning, performance measurement